

Effective Programming Practices for Economists

Software engineering

What does pytest do?

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Example

consider this hypothetical survey about a programming course

```
>>> raw = pd.read_csv("survey.csv")
>>> raw
```

	Q001	Q002	Q003
0	strongly disagree	agree	python
1	strongly agree	strongly agree	Python
2	-77	disagree	R
3	agree	-77	Python
4	-99	-99	Python
5	NaN	strongly agree	Python
6	neutral	strongly agree	Python
7	disagree	agree	python
8	strongly agree	-99	PYTHON
9	agree	-99	Ypthon

From the metadata you know

- Q001: I am a coding genius
- Q001: I learned a lot
- Q003: What is your favourite language
- -77 not readable
- -99 no reply

Two functions in clean_data.py

```
def _clean_agreement_scale(sr):  
    sr = sr.replace({"-77": pd.NA, "-99": pd.NA})  
    categories = ["strongly disagree", "disagree", "neutral", "agree", "strongly agree"]  
    dtype = pd.CategoricalDtype(categories=categories, ordered=True)  
    return sr.astype(dtype)
```

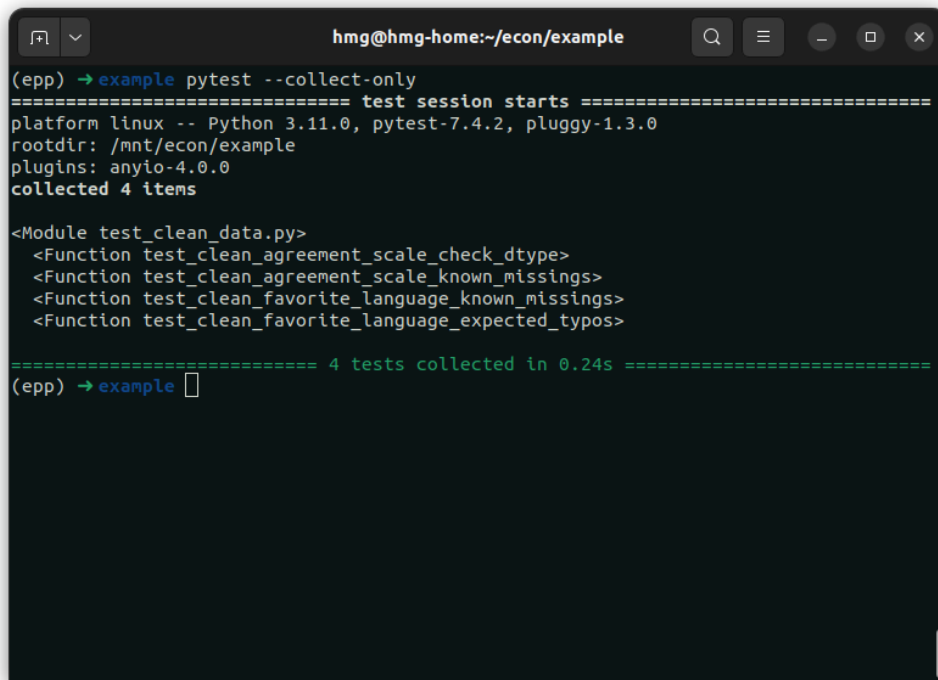
```
def _clean_favorite_language(sr):  
    sr = sr.replace({"-77": pd.NA, "-99": pd.NA})  
    sr = sr.str.lower().str.strip()  
    sr = sr.replace("ypthon", "python")  
    return sr.astype(pd.CategoricalDtype())
```

New module: `test_clean_data.py`

- 4 assertions whether actual results match our expectation
- Will look at syntax in subsequent screencast

Step 1: Collection

- Go through all folders in working directory
- Collect all files with name `test_XXX.py`
- Go through those files and collect all functions that start with `test_`
- All these test functions will be executed (fine-grained control possible)

A terminal window with a dark background and light text. The title bar shows the user 'hmg' at 'hmg-home' in the directory '~/econ/example'. The prompt is '(epp)'. The user has entered '→ example pytest --collect-only'. The output shows the start of a test session, platform and Python version information, root directory, plugins, and that 4 items were collected. It then lists the module 'test_clean_data.py' and four functions: 'test_clean_agreement_scale_check_dtype', 'test_clean_agreement_scale_known_missings', 'test_clean_favorite_language_known_missings', and 'test_clean_favorite_language_expected_ttypes'. Finally, it reports that 4 tests were collected in 0.24s. The prompt is now '(epp) → example' followed by a cursor.

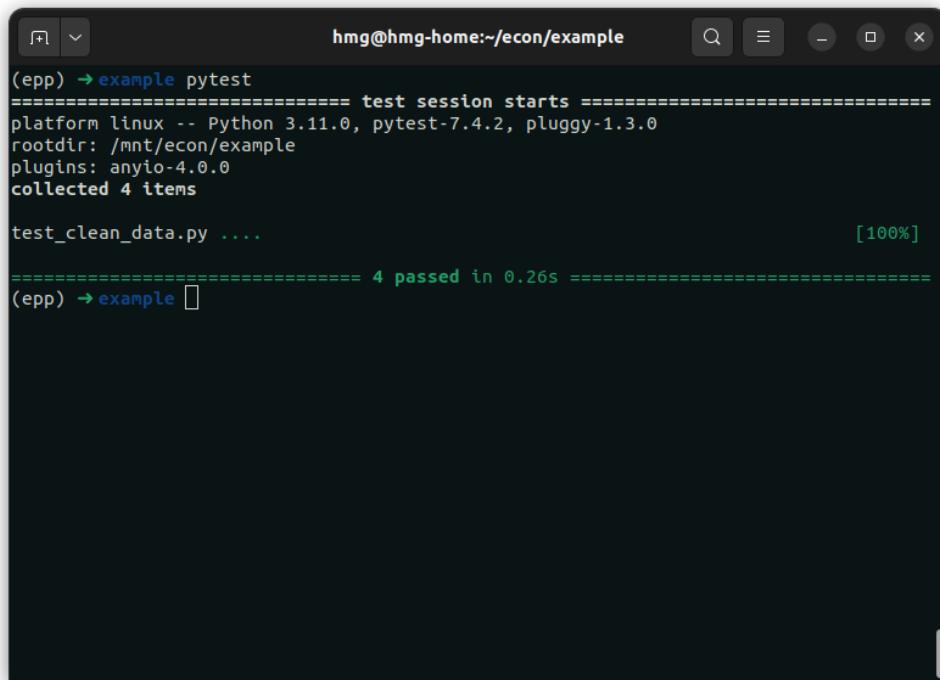
```
hmg@hmg-home:~/econ/example
(epp) → example pytest --collect-only
===== test session starts =====
platform linux -- Python 3.11.0, pytest-7.4.2, pluggy-1.3.0
rootdir: /mnt/econ/example
plugins: anyio-4.0.0
collected 4 items

<Module test_clean_data.py>
  <Function test_clean_agreement_scale_check_dtype>
  <Function test_clean_agreement_scale_known_missings>
  <Function test_clean_favorite_language_known_missings>
  <Function test_clean_favorite_language_expected_ttypes>

===== 4 tests collected in 0.24s =====
(epp) → example
```

Step 2: Execute the tests

- All test functions are executed
- A report is printed to the screen

A terminal window with a dark background and light text. The title bar shows the user 'hmg' at 'hmg-home' in the directory '~/econ/example'. The prompt is '(epp)'. The user has entered '→ example pytest'. The output shows the start of a test session, including platform, Python version, pytest version, root directory, plugins, and collected items. It then shows the execution of 'test_clean_data.py' with a progress indicator '[100%]' and a final summary '4 passed in 0.26s'. The prompt is now '(epp) → example' followed by a cursor.

```
hmg@hmg-home:~/econ/example

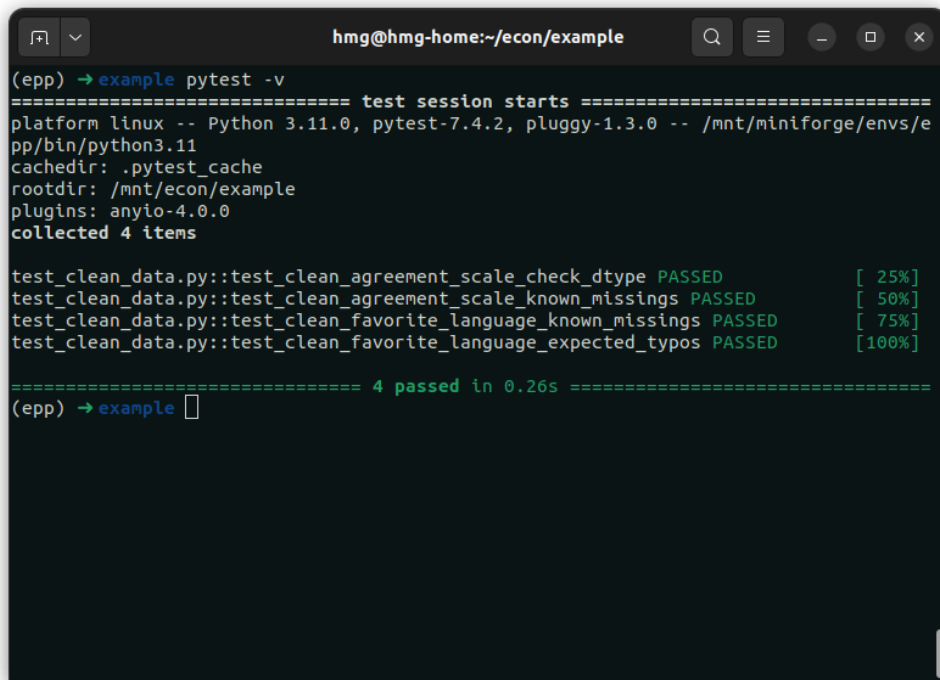
(epp) → example pytest
===== test session starts =====
platform linux -- Python 3.11.0, pytest-7.4.2, pluggy-1.3.0
rootdir: /mnt/econ/example
plugins: anyio-4.0.0
collected 4 items

test_clean_data.py .... [100%]

===== 4 passed in 0.26s =====
(epp) → example
```

Step 2: Execute the tests

- `pytest -v` gives more detailed progress reports
- Can be very helpful for long-running tests

A terminal window with a dark background and light text. The title bar shows the user 'hmg' at 'hmg-home' in the directory '~/econ/example'. The prompt is '(epp)'. The user has entered '→ example pytest -v'. The output shows a detailed test session report. It starts with '==== test session starts ====' followed by platform and Python version information. It lists the root directory as '/mnt/econ/example' and shows that 4 items were collected. The four tests are listed with their progress percentages: 25%, 50%, 75%, and 100%. All tests passed. The session ended with '==== 4 passed in 0.26s =====' and the prompt '(epp) → example' with a cursor.

```
(epp) → example pytest -v
===== test session starts =====
platform linux -- Python 3.11.0, pytest-7.4.2, pluggy-1.3.0 -- /mnt/miniforge/envs/e
pp/bin/python3.11
cachedir: .pytest_cache
rootdir: /mnt/econ/example
plugins: anyio-4.0.0
collected 4 items

test_clean_data.py::test_clean_agreement_scale_check_dtype PASSED [ 25%]
test_clean_data.py::test_clean_agreement_scale_known_missings PASSED [ 50%]
test_clean_data.py::test_clean_favorite_language_known_missings PASSED [ 75%]
test_clean_data.py::test_clean_favorite_language_expected_typos PASSED [100%]

===== 4 passed in 0.26s =====
(epp) → example
```

Step 3: Inspect failures

```

hmg@hmg-home:~/econ/example

(epp) → example pytest
===== test session starts =====
platform linux -- Python 3.11.0, pytest-7.4.2, pluggy-1.3.0
rootdir: /mnt/econ/example
plugins: anyio-4.0.0
collected 4 items

test_clean_data.py .F.. [100%]

===== FAILURES =====
_____ test_clean_agreement_scale_known_missings _____

def test_clean_agreement_scale_known_missings():
    sr = pd.Series(["-77", "-99"])
    result = _clean_agreement_scale(sr)
    expected = pd.Series([pd.NA, "agree"], dtype=result.dtype)
    pd.testing.assert_series_equal(result, expected)

test_clean_data.py:16:
testing.pyx:55: in pandas._libs.testing.assert_almost_equal
    ???
-----
> ???
E   AssertionError: Series are different
E
E   Series values are different (50.0 %)
E   [index]: [0, 1]
E   [left]:  [NaN, NaN]
E   Categories (5, string): [strongly disagree < disagree < neutral < agree < strongly agree]
E   [right]: [NaN, 'agree']
E   Categories (5, string): [strongly disagree < disagree < neutral < agree < strongly agree]
E   At positional index 1, first diff: nan != agree

testing.pyx:173: AssertionError
===== short test summary info =====
FAILED test_clean_data.py::test_clean_agreement_scale_known_missings - AssertionError: Series are different
===== 1 failed, 3 passed in 0.31s =====
(epp) → example

```


[illegible]